N E W S L E T T E R

Congregation Tifereth Israel
Sephardic

VOLUME 56 NO. 2 **MARCH, 2026**





The staff of the *Newsletter* wishes everyone a happy Purim which is celebrated on the 14th of Adar, Tuesday, March 3. The story of Purim is told in the Megillah, the Book of Esther, which is read in its entirety on the eve of Purim, Monday, March 2.

We also wish everyone a joyous and healthy Passover which begins with the first Seder on Wednesday, April 1. On Passover, we gather in our homes with our family and friends to commemorate our voyage from slavery to freedom. Passover is also a sure sign of spring and with that comes the renewal of our worshipping together in person for our Friday night Shabbat Services. Please mark your calendar for our return on April 24, and plan to join us in the synagogue.

CANDLE LIGHTING TIMES FOR SHABBAT:

March 6	5:22	April 3	6:54
March 13	6:30	April 10	7:02
March 20	6:38	April 17	7:10
March 27	6:46	April 24	7:18

From the Presidents...

As I write this wishing for the end of winter, we are preparing for yet another storm, with possible blizzard conditions and up to two feet of heavy wet snow to shovel. As a result, I am looking forward to our spring Shabbat service which will be back in the synagogue April 24, followed by the congregation meeting on April 26.

The election for officers and board members for the next two years will take place at the congregation meeting in April. The nominating committee has met and is proposing a slate for your consideration. While they are proposing no changes, and we appreciate everyone's confidence, it would be nice to see some new blood in the mix. New people always come with new ideas and methods for accomplishing what they are proposing. That is not to say that the old guard isn't capable of doing the job, but there are some members that would like to step down if we could fill their positions. Please give this some thought as nominations will be accepted from the membership when the election takes place.

Happy Passover to everyone!

Shalom,
Jerry Pressman, President

Happy Purim! Spring is just around the corner! With that being said, our next Ladies' Auxiliary Meeting has been scheduled on Zoom for Thursday night, March 26th at 7:30 PM. I hope you will all be in attendance. We will be holding elections. Anyone interested in running for office should contact us through our email:

ladies-auxiliary@ctipeabody.org

We will also be discussing dates for a fun-filled Sunday afternoon of games and snacks at the Synagogue.

Please watch your email for the next selection and date of our monthly book club, and join us for another lively discussion!

Fran Arsenault-Shaheen
President, Ladies Auxiliary

Thank you to the following members and friends who have made donations to CTI in memory of their loved ones whose Meldathos were observed during recent Shabbat services and those members who have recently passed on:

Donated by	In Memory Of
Paula Cohen	Leonard Cohen - Husband
Paula Cohen	Norma & Eli Alpert - Parents
Nancy Duerr	Kenneth (Kenny) Furtado - Brother
Diane Elefson	Mary & Harold Sumberg - Parents
Harvey Elefson	Leonard Elefson - Brother
Harvey Elefson	Ida Elefson - Mother
David Gibeley	Albert Gibeley - Father
David Gibeley	Esther Gibeley - Grandmother
Arnold Gitter	Samuel Gitter - Father
Arnold Gitter	Heidi Sue Gitter - Daughter
Judith Gitter	Edward Baum - Father
Doris Hershoff	Joshua Yonis - Brother
Doris Hershoff	Sara Yonis - Sister
Cynthia Linsky	Joshua Yonis - Father
Betty & Jay Polonsky	Shirley Shapiro - Mother
Joanne Pressman	Joseph Havian - Grandfather
Joanne Pressman	Joseph Pernitchi - Grandfather
Jerry Pressman	Matilda Barber - Grandmother
Ann Segal	Ada Millstein - Mother
Fran & John Shaheen	Rose Hasday - Mother
Barbara Silverman	Lloyd Silverman - Husband
Barbara Silverman	Nelson Gediman - Brother
Marcia Smokler	Mathew Smokler - Husband
Wendy Tirck	Ruth Parkin - Goodman - Mother
Linda Weaver	Joshua Yonis - Father
Linda Weaver	Bob Weaver - Husband

THANK YOU

To Betty Polonsky, Josh Polonsky and Jay Rowen for their assistance in clearing snow from the stairs and sidewalk of the synagogue.

SPRING MEETINGS:

A meeting of the Officers and Board of Directors will be held on **Thursday, March 12**, at 7:30 PM, on Zoom.

A meeting of the Ladies Auxiliary will be held on **Thursday, March 26,** at 7:30 PM, on Zoom.

A general meeting of the entire Congregation will be held on **Sunday, April 26.** The business meeting will begin at 10:00 and elections for the next two years will take place, so please make every effort to attend. Coffee and tea will be available.

NOMINATING COMITTEE:

The Nominating Committee has submitted the following slate of officers and board members. Additional nominations will be taken from the floor prior to the vote, and we encourage other members to submit their names for consideration.

Officers:

President - Jerry Pressman
Vice President - Betty Polonsky
Treasurer - Jay Polonsky
Secretary - Joanne Pressman

Board Members:

Millie Becker, Harvey Elefson, Doris Hershoff, Marvin Menovich, David Podradchik, and Wendy Tirck. Per the CTI By-laws, Fran Arsenault-Shaheen, President of the Ladies Auxiliary, also serves as an appointed board member.

A PERSONAL APPEAL:

Since 1991, I have been leading the services and trying to keep the Sephardic melodies and prayers a viable and important part of our High Holiday and Shabbat observances. At the November Congregation meeting and in the January *Newsletter*, I offered to start a choir of our members to learn the Hebrew prayers of our ancestors during the summer months, and to join their voices with mine to enhance the Sephardic tradition that makes Congregation Tifereth Israel unique. Only a few people responded positively at the meeting, and no one else has expressed an interest in helping since then. After 35 years of leading the prayers as a soloist, we all need to face the reality that we need more member participation if we are to continue. Please consider joining in this important endeavor! Email to: info@ctipeabody.org.

Joanne Pressman, Cantorial Soloist

FRIDAY EVENING SERVICE DATES

Nisan - March 20	Iyar - April 24
Sivan - May 22	Tamuz - June 19
Av - July 17	Elul - August 14

All services begin at 7:30 P. M. and include the reading of the Yahrzeit memorial names for that Hebrew month. The March service will be held only on Zoom. Watch your email for the link or phone number to participate. Starting in April, we will be back in the synagogue and hope to see you there!

YAHRZEIT - MELDATHOS

MARCH		NISSAN
Service Friday March 20, 7:30 PM		
19	Sarah Liberty	1
19	Shelley Sherry	1
21	S. Robert Fermon	3
22	Harry Harsfield	4
26	E. Judith Castiglione	8
27	Joseph Gibeley, I	9
28	Kay Becker	10
28	Esther Gibely II	10
31	Sarah Smith Gibely	13
APRIL		
1	Morris Gibely	14
2	Leonard Gibely	15
2	Isaac Hasday	15
2	Irving Fermon	15
3	Lillian Aronson	16
3	Gertrude Hamilt	16
3	Dorothy Blair	16
4	Raymond Castiglione	17
8	Maya Seriy	21
9	Maurice Melamed	22
11	Herman J. Freedman	24
11	Rebecca Stein	24
13	Irving Shapiro	26
14	Abraham Hershoff	27
16	Eliza Abouav	29
16	Bessie Shapiro	29
17	Herman E. Bail	30

APRIL		IYAR
Service Friday April 24, 7:30 PM		
20	Jacob Fermon	3
21	Yontov Gibeley	4
22	Mary Gediman	5
23	David Miller	6
24	Joseph Gibely, III	7
25	Jacob Berman	8
25	E. Judith Castiglione	8
26	Ralph (Skippy) Yonis	9
26	Michael Seriy	9
27	Nissim Eskenazi	10
28	Simon Rosenberg	11
30	Melvin Goldman	13
MAY		
2	David Savy	15
3	Irving Gibley	16
3	Rabbi Dov B. Pikelny	16
4	Abraham Podradchik	17
5	Anne Rosenberg	18
7	Samuel Savy	20
8	Maya Seriy	21
8	Sheryl Becker	21
11	Esther Podradchik	24
15	Jennie Havian	28
16	Marilyn Havian	29

BIRTHDAYS

MARCH		APRIL	
1	Mark Polonsky	3	Joanne Polonsky
3	Andrew Elefson	3	Sherry Yonis
5	William Jagher	4	Arthur Black
8	Caitlin Becker	6	Sherri Rappaport
8	Nancy Duerr	13	Max Sontz
11	Ryan Elliot Thompson	14	Jackson Arsenault
12	Michael Goldberg	16	Fran Shaheen
16	Meredith Linsky	20	Judith Gitter
22	Cindy Jane Shenker	24	Heather Jagher
25	Joseph Savy	24	Mackenzie Colgan
27	Tammy Gitter	27	Scott Podradchik
30	Jessica Arsenault		
30	Arlene Shenker		

ANNIVERSARIES

MARCH

6 Mr. & Mrs. Harvey Elefson

11 Mr. & Mrs. Arnold Gitter

APRIL

3 Mr. & Mrs. Craig Podradchik

GET WELL WISHES

Heidi August, Millie Becker, Donna Bean Berman, Nancy Duerr, Andrew Elefson, Barbara Forbes, Robert Furtado, Cynthia Garber, Judi Gitter, Carole Hanak, Ron Hanak, Ellen Jagher, Steve Linsky, Ilene Garber MacDonald, Mary Jo Petrone, Paula Podradchik, Ryan Podradchik, Jay Polonsky, Jerry Pressman, Jack Romo, Sheila Romo, Ann Segal, Gloria Sontz, Harvey Tanzer, and Wendy Tirck.